

sales were around 60 million units, and the iPad occupied a market share of about 35 to 40 million units while the remaining was divided among the other companies. The Blackberry Playbook's miserable sales, owing to the poor ecosystem of apps and developers, would also bear testimony to this.

Since mobile apps are so ubiquitous, they have also had a major impact on the gaming industry. Gaming has always been one of the most competitive industries, and mobile apps have brought a whole new dimensions to it. People are being introduced into gaming through their smartphones and tablets, instead of the traditional gaming consoles. Videogames are being played now more than ever before, even as handheld game consoles are losing their market dominance, and this has given rise to a new breed of gamers: the casual gamer, and the goal of the industry catering to this category of gamers, being to present a pick-up-and-play experience that people from almost any age group or skill level could enjoy. So it comes as no surprise when a recent survey found, that more than 30 percent of app users are moving away from their handheld gaming consoles. But if mobile apps are giving the hardcore gaming industry a run for their money, they are also bringing in new jobs and funds to the gaming industry. Games are the most frequently used mobile apps, and most people are still willing to pay to play. This presents an opportunity to smaller developers to get noticed and sell their game to potentially millions without needing a huge budget or a great marketing campaign. The future for 'casual gamers' looks bright, with Android devices and Apple pushing for larger resolutions. This can only mean more developer support from game developers, which means better games, which in turn can only mean one thing – more gaming.

It is undeniable that mobile applications have triggered a fundamental shift in the way people experience computing and use their handheld devices. It has helped simplify most of the daily tasks in life, probably making us a lot more reliant on electronic devices. About a decade ago, the web revolutionised the way people went about their lives, and now mobile applications are well on their way to replacing web browsers. And with infinite potential for development, it would not need a soothsayer to predict that the mobile app boom will go on for a while simplifying our lives tremendously.

11 coolest apps for iPad and Android

Confucius says "Man who be cool have cool apps on tablet" – So load your tablet with the most pimpin' apps that will make your friends go 'Woah!' The following is a list of 11 Cool apps you need for your tablet.